

The Economic Journal

2024 Annual Report

March 2025

The Economic Journal is one of the founding journals of modern economics. Since 1891 the journal has provided a platform for high-quality, imaginative economic research, earning a worldwide reputation for excellence as a general interest journal, publishing papers in all fields of economics for a broad international readership.

The Economic Journal welcomes submissions whether they be theoretical, applied, or orientated towards academics or policymakers.

Highlights

Submissions and Impact

- In 2024, the Journal received 1,538 new submissions (including 272 short papers), compared to 1,259 in 2023 (229 short papers).
- The 2024 acceptance rate was 6% (2023: 7%).
- The Journal published 117 articles in volume 134 (2024) (2023: 107 articles, volume 133).
- Of the 117 published articles, 17 were short papers (2023: 17).
- The Journal is ranked twelfth in Economics by Google Scholar (2023: twelfth).
- Twitter/X followers increased slightly to 23.8k as of February 2025, (2023: 22.5k).
- In 2024, the number of Altmetric mentions for all research published in the Journal was 4,683 (2023: 7,368). This is largely due to a significant decrease in Twitter/X mentions from 6,083 during 2023 to 3,305 in 2024.

Turnaround times

- Average decision turnaround times for all papers in 2024 was 37 days (2023: 43). Average turnaround times for all papers, excluding those that are desk rejected was 62 days (2022: 77). In 2024, 88% of decisions were made by Editors within 3 months (2023: 78%).
- The Journal continues to benefit from dedicated referees and Associate Editors who deliver high-quality and timely reports, with 98% returning their reports within 3 months in 2024 (94% in 2023). The average turnaround time for referee to return report to Editor was 40 days (2023: 51 days).

Operations and People

- There is 1 Editor-in-Chief, 1 Special Issues Editor, and 8 Editors.
- Francesco Lippi is the Journal's Editor-in-Chief (since August 2021).
- Alberto Bisin joined as Special Issues Editor in September 2024.
- Paola Manzini joined as Editor in January 2025.
- Florian Oswald continued as RES Data Editor (since July 2023).
- 61 Associate Editors served the Journal during 2024 (2023: 58).

1. Editorial Board and Office

1.1. Current Editorial Team

Editor-in-Chief

Francesco Lippi, LUISS University and Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance

Editors

Heski Bar-Isaac, University of Toronto

Sascha O. Becker, University of Warwick and Monash University

Steffen Huck, WZB Berlin Social Science Center & University College London

Namrata Kala, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Paola Manzini, University of Bristol

Franck Portier, University College London

Roland Rathelot, ENSAE

Basit Zafar, University of Michigan

Special Issues Editor

Alberto Bisin, New York University

RES Data Editor

Florian Oswald, Sciences Po

Senior Publications Manager

Brooke Sperry, Royal Economic Society

Editorial Office Support

Editorial Office Limited

Associate Editors

Attila Ambrus, Duke University

Elliott Ash, ETH Zurich

Jeanet Sinding Bentzen, University of Copenhagen

Sonia Bhalotra, University of Warwick

Yves Breitmoser, Bielefeld University

Anne Brockmeyer, World Bank

Lorenzo Casaburi, University of Zurich

Laurens Cherchye, KU Leuven
 Wei Cui, University College London *
 Eugen Dimant, University of Pennsylvania *
 Ruben Durante, National University of Singapore and ICREA-UPF *
 Wiola Dzuida, University of Chicago
 Daniel Ferreira, LSE
 Thiemo Fetzner, University of Warwick
 Patricia Funk, Università della Svizzera Italiana
 Pamela Giustinelli, Bocconi University *
 Selim Gulesci, Trinity College Dublin
 Stephan Heblich, University of Toronto
 David Hemous, University of Zurich
 Erik Hornung, University of Cologne
 Ruixue Jia, University of California San Diego
 Judd B. Kessler, University of Pennsylvania
 Terri Kneeland, University College London
 Horacio Larreguy, Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México
 Gianmarco Leon-Ciliotta, Universitat Pompeu Fabra
 Weijia Li, Monash University *
 Aniol Llorente-Saguer, Queen Mary University of London
 Andrei Markevich, University of Helsinki / The New Economic School
 Paolo Martellini, New York University
 Michael McMahon, University of Oxford
 Guy Michaels, LSE
 Joan Monras, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *
 Peter Nilsson, Institute for International Economic Studies
 Jörg Oechssler, University of Heidelberg *
 Scott Orr, University of British Columbia
 Fernando Parro, University of Rochester
 Juan Passadore, International Monetary Fund
 Erik Plug, University of Amsterdam
 Andrea Polo, LUISS University, EIEF
 Anja Prummer, Freie Universität Berlin
 Christopher Rauh, University of Cambridge
 Dominic Rohner, University of Lausanne
 Pauline Rossi, ENSAE *
 Edouard Schaal, Centre de Recerca en Economia Internacional (CREI)
 Laura Schechter, University of Wisconsin-Madison
 Michel Serafinelli, University of Essex
 Marta Serra-Garcia, University of California San Diego
 Andrew Shephard, University of Pennsylvania
 Abhijeet Singh, Stockholm School of Economics
 Pedro Souza, Queen Mary University of London
 Ferdinand Vieider, Ghent University *
 Miaojie Yu, Liaoning University *
 Francesco Zanetti, University of Oxford

1.2. Editorial Board changes

- Alberto Bisin joined as Special Issues Editor from September 2024.
- Paola Manzini joined as Editor in January 2025.
- Amanda Friedenbergr completed term as Editor in March 2025.
- Associate Editors who joined during 2024 are indicated with an asterisk (*)
- The following Associate Editors completed terms during 2024: Aurélien Baillon, Emlyon Business School; Natalia Fabra, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (UC3M); Mariassunta Giannetti, Stockholm School of Economics; Andrei Levchenko, University of Michigan; Arash Nekoei, Stockholm University; Emanuel Vespa, University of California, San Diego; David Yang, Harvard University; Noam Yuchtman, LSE.

2. Journal Policies

2.1 Submissions Requirements

The Economic Journal publishes academic papers that significantly advance knowledge. The Editorial Board welcomes high-quality submissions in all fields of economics, independent of method and perspective, including applied submissions on policy-relevant questions that make an important contribution by demonstrating precisely identified zero effects.

The Editorial Board is committed to providing rapid feedback to submitting authors.

The Editorial Board welcomes submissions which adhere to the [Instructions to Authors](#). Manuscripts that do not meet the requirements will not be considered for publication.

2.2 Data Replication Policy & Guidance

The Economic Journal [Data Editor website](#) provides all relevant information on the Data and Code Availability Policy and pre-acceptance reproducibility checks implemented at the Journal.

The replication policies are also included in [Section 4](#) of the Instructions to Authors.

The Data Editors of the American Economic Association, the Review of Economic Studies, the Canadian Journal of Economics, the Econometric Society, and The Economic Journal and The Econometrics Journal coordinate reproducibility requirements and guidelines across journals. An example is the [common guidance](#) developed by Social Science Data Editors.

2.3 Special Issues

In September 2024 it was announced that The Economic Journal will publish special issues. Papers published in special issues (or in special sections of regular issues) will be high quality, themed, focused on questions of high relevance to society and academia, subject to fast editorial turnaround processes, with content generated through open calls.

Two special issue Calls were issued in autumn 2024: 'Climate Change and Inequality' and 'Polarization in Field Experiments'.

2.4 Publication Ethics Policies

The journal is a member of the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) and adheres to the [COPE Guidelines](#) to ensure that best publication ethics practices are upheld.

The Economic Journal has also produced [Ethics Policies](#) for authors, reviewers and editors. Further guidance is available from the [Oxford University Press best practice guidelines](#) for publication ethics.

2.5 Submission Fee Policy

To be eligible to submit to The Economic Journal authors must agree to pay the relevant submission fee. A discounted fee is available to RES members. Full information including Terms & Conditions and the RES Membership and Submission Fee Schedule is available on the RES website: [RES Submission Fee Policy](#).

3. Journal Statistics

3.1. Submissions (Tables 1 & 2)

In 2024, the Journal received 1,538 new submissions (including 272 short papers), compared to 1,259 in 2023 (229 short papers). The total number of submissions for 2024 including resubmissions is 1,890 (2023: 1,596).

The acceptance rate for 2024 is 6% (2023: 7%). The rate of desk reject decisions in 2024 is 43% (2023: 44%).

The geographical distribution (Table 2) of submissions is in line with recent years, with the largest share of submissions (37%) coming from Europe (2023: 42%). Twenty-three percent of submissions came from the US & Canada (2023: 22%). Submissions from the UK accounted for 14% of submissions in 2024 (2023: 12%).

3.1.1. Short paper submissions (Table 1)

The Journal introduced a short paper article type in July 2020, similar to the AER: Insights style (<6,000 words, 5 exhibits). Short papers are held to the same quality

standards as regular submissions, and the same editorial decision processes in terms of refereeing apply.

In 2024, 272 short papers were received as new submissions (2023: 229), accounting for 18% of new submissions (2023: 18%).

3.2. Editorial Processing Times (Tables 3-4)

Table 3 provides statistics on turnaround times for submitted papers. Average decision turnaround times for all papers in 2024 was 37 days (2023: 43). Average turnaround times for all papers, excluding those that are desk rejected was 62 days (2022: 77).

The percentage of all papers where the Editor responded to the author within 14 days has decreased slightly from 55% in 2023 to 52% in 2024. However, in 2024, 88% of decisions were made by Editors within 3 months (2023: 78%) and for the fourth consecutive year, all papers were handled within 6 months.

Table 4 shows that referees are also returning their reports promptly, with 98% of reviews being returned within 3 months (2023: 94%). The average turnaround time for referee to return report to Editor was 40 days in 2024 (2023: 51 days).

Desk reject papers are not sent for review, therefore turnaround times for these papers remain low. The average turnaround time for desk reject decisions has remained stable at 6 days in 2024 (2023: 6).

3.3. Impact Factors (Table 5)

Table 5 shows The Economic Journal's 2-Year Impact Factor, compared with those of competitors. The Journal's 2023 IF (published in June 2024) increased from 3.2 (2022) to 3.8. This compares with 7.6 for The Review of Economics and Statistics, 3.9 for the Journal of the European Economic Association and 5.9 for The Review of Economic Studies. The Journal's 2023 5-year Impact Factor is 4.5 (2022: 4.2). It is ranked twelfth by Google Scholar in the field of Economics.

3.3.1. Altmetrics and Social media

The Journal's Twitter / X account (@EJ_RES) is used to promote recently accepted and published articles and journal news and had 23.8k followers in February 2025 (February 2024: 22.5k). The Royal Economic Society Twitter / X account (@RoyalEconSoc) also regularly promotes journal articles and news and has 19.9k followers (2023: 19.1k).

The Appendix shows the Top 12 Altmetric scoring articles at the end of 2024. Altmetric measures the online attention (mentions) of published articles by several indicators, including social media, public policy, and news outlets.

In 2024, the number of Altmetric mentions for all research published in the Journal was 4,683 (2023: 7,368). This is largely due to a significant decrease in Twitter/X mentions from 6,083 during 2023 to 3,305 in 2024.

In November 2024 the Royal Economic Society joined Bluesky Social (@resmedia.bsky.social). The Society promotes recently accepted articles and posts Journal News. As of February 2025 the account has 2.1k followers.

4. Prizes

4.1. The Austin Robinson Memorial Prize

The Austin Robinson Memorial Prize is awarded to the best paper published in the Journal in a given year by an author (or multiple authors) who is (or are) within 5 years of receiving their PhD. The winning paper is selected by the Editors.

The 2023 Austin Robinson Memorial Prize was awarded to Gustav Agneman and Esther Chevrot-Bianco for 'Market Participation and Moral Decision-Making: Experimental Evidence from Greenland' published in Volume 133, Issue 650 (February 2023). The Prize was awarded during the annual RES conference at Queen's University Belfast in March 2024. The 2024 Prize will be awarded during the RES conference at the University of Birmingham in July 2025.

4.2. The Royal Economic Society (RES) Prize

The RES Prize is awarded to the best paper published in the Journal in a given year. It is selected by a prize committee consisting of the RES President, the Editor-in-Chief and a member of the RES Council.

The 2023 RES Prize was awarded to Fabio Cerina, Elisa Dienesch, Alessio Moro and Michelle Rendall for 'Spatial Polarisation' published in Volume 133, Issue 649 (January 2023). The 2024 winner will be announced at the 2025 RES conference.

4.3. Referee Prizes

The Economic Journal recognises the contribution of exceptional referees with its annual Referee Prizes. The 2024 winners were announced in February 2025:

Stergios Athanasoglou, University of Milan
David P. Byrne, University of Melbourne
Efrem Castelnuovo, University of Padova
Ruben Durante, National University of Singapore and ICREA-UPF
Rick Harbaugh, Indiana University
Ashley Langer, University of Arizona
Martin O'Connell, University of Wisconsin-Madison
Andrey Ordin, University of Texas at Austin

Dotan Persitz, Tel Aviv University
Jared Rubin, Chapman University
Cole Williams, Durham University

5. Events and Special Content

5.1. The Economic Journal Lecture

Ben Moll (London School of Economics and Political Science) delivered the 2024 Economic Journal Lecture at the RES Conference (Queen's University Belfast, March 2024). The Lecture, '[Heterogeneous Agent Macroeconomics: Eight Lessons and a Challenge](#),' was chaired by Editor Franck Portier.

5.2. Virtual Issues

The Economic Journal published two virtual issues in 2024. All virtual issue articles are available Free-to-View for a limited time (6 months).

The first was [Religion and Economics](#) (June 2024), with a foreword by Editor Sascha O. Becker. The issue compiles 16 papers published in the Journal which exemplify how the discipline has approached the economics of religion, both theoretically and empirically. The topics covered include an economic theory of church strictness; comparisons of work and social ethics of Protestants and Catholics; patterns of adoption of new religions; witch trials; discrimination between religious and non-religious groups; the economic consequences of Ramadan; and many more. The empirical papers cover multiple continents, and multiple millennia.

The second was [Lessons from Covid-19 and the economics of pandemics](#) (December 2024), with a foreword by Editor-in-Chief Francesco Lippi and Editor Steffen Huck. This virtual issue brings together 16 papers that explore various dimensions of the pandemic's impact and are grouped into three broad categories: (a) the general economics of infectious diseases and pandemics, (b) the evaluation of policies to manage COVID-19, and (c) the use of the pandemic as an experiment to shed light on interesting economic phenomena.

5.3 Featured Articles

The Editors selected eight Featured Articles during 2024, one per issue. These articles are available Free-to-View for a limited time:

'Deliberate Surrender? The Impact of Interwar Indian Protection'
Vellore Arthi, Markus Lampe, Ashwin Nair, Kevin Hjortshøj O'Rourke
Volume 134, Issue 657, January 2024

'The Boss is Watching: How Monitoring Decisions Hurt Black Workers'

Costas Cavounidis, Kevin Lang, Russell Weinstein
Volume 134, Issue 658, February 2024

'p-Hacking, Data type and Data-Sharing Policy'
Abel Brodeur, Nikolai Cook, Carina Neisser
Volume 134, Issue 659, April 2024

'The Political Scar of Epidemics'
Barry Eichengreen, Orkun Saka, Cevat Giray
Volume 134, Issue 660, May 2024

'Making Policies Matter: Voter Responses to Campaign Promises'
Cesi Cruz, Philip Keefer, Julien Labonne, Francesco Trebbi
Volume 134, Issue 661, July 2024

'Political Language in Economics'
Zubin Jelveh, Bruce Kogut, Suresh Naidu
Volume 134, Issue 662, August 2024

'Fair Pension Policies with Occupation-Specific Ageing'
Volker Grossmann, Johannes Schünemann, Holger Strulik
Volume 134, Issue 663, October 2024

'Cash Versus Kind: Benchmarking a Child Nutrition Program Against Unconditional
Cash Transfers in Rwanda'
Craig McIntosh, Andrew Zeitlin
Volume 134, Issue 664, November 2024

Table 1: Submissions and Decisions

Submissions (All Submissions: First, Second, etc.)

Year	Submitted Total	Submitted Regular	New submissions	Special Issue papers	Accepted	Conditionally Accepted	Returned for revisions	Rejected	Summarily Rejected	Pending	Withdrawn/ to be removed	Total
2024	1890	1890 (**338)	1538 (**272)	7	108(**13)	103(**20)	232(**52)	536(**105)	805(**133)	101(**16)	5(**2)	1890
2023	1596	1596 (**277)	1259 (**229)	0	115(**17)	103(**13)	193(**35)	393(**59)	701(**140)	89(**13)	2(**0)	1596
2022	1673	1673 (**277)	1348 (**224)	0	87(**12)	108(**19)	199(**30)	374(**52)	777 (**138)	124(**24)	4	1673
2021	1929	1929 (**236)	1633 (**214)	0	104 (**7)	96(**8)	191(**28)	439(**55)	968(**125)	131(**13)	0	1929
2020	1994	1994 (**119)	1687	0	121	92	153 (**4)	456(**28)	950(**68)	221(**19)	1	1994

*Results taken from January 1 to December 31.

** Short papers.

Table 2: Geographical Distribution of First Regular Submissions

Regions	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
UNITED KINGDOM	216 (14%)	151 (12%)	197 (15%)	242 (15%)	259 (15%)
USA & CANADA	351 (23%)	274 (22%)	311 (23%)	405	425 (25%)
UNITED STATES (US)	318	232	273	365	367
CANADA (CA)	33	42	38	40	58
EUROPE	569 (37%)	530 (42%)	528 (39%)	638 (39%)	657 (39%)
BELGIUM (BE)	11	18	16	18	18
FRANCE (FR)	66	55	54	58	67
GERMANY (DE)	129	145	151	164	186
ITALY (IT)	79	66	59	78	71
NETHERLANDS (NL)	36	48	41	52	51
SCANDINAVIA	99	73	81	94	95
SPAIN (ES)	49	31	29	47	50
OTHER EUROPE	100	95	97	127	119
REST OF THE WORLD	402 (26%)	304 (24%)	312 (23%)	348 (21%)	346 (21%)
AUSTRALIA (AU)	48	32	39	53	46
NEW ZEALAND (NZ)	5	2	9	5	9
CHINA (CN)	185	120	122	110	100
HONG KONG (HK)	24	16	14	21	21
INDIA (IN)	11	14	12	10	10
ISRAEL (IL)	11	10	8	16	25
JAPAN (JP)	30	26	20	36	47
OTHER	88	84	88	97	88

*Results taken from January 1 to December 31.

Table 3: Time Taken from Submission for Editor to Respond to Author with Decision (for First Regular Submissions)

	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
ALL PAPERS					
0-14 days	52%	55%	56%	61%	55%
15 days - 1 month	6%	4%	5%	5%	5%
1-2 months	13%	4%	3%	3%	3%
2-3 months	17%	15%	13%	14%	13%
3-4 months	9%	16%	16%	13%	9%
4-5 months	3%	5%	6%	4%	5%
5-6 months	0%	1%	0%	0%	3%
more than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	7%
Average turnaround time in days	37 days	43 days	43 days	34 days	53 days

SUMMARILY REJECTED					
0-14 days	93%	95%	93%	93%	92%
15 days - 1 month	7%	5%	6%	6%	7%
1-2 months	0%	0%	0.5%	0%	0%
2-3 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
3-4 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
4-5 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
5-6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
more than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Average turnaround time in days	6 days	6 days	6 days	5 days	7 days
PAPERS SENT TO REFEREES					
0-14 days	18%	19%	17%	6%	8%
15 days - 1 month	5%	2%	3%	4%	3%
1-2 months	24%	8%	5%	6%	6%
2-3 months	31%	29%	28%	38%	29%
3-4 months	16%	30%	34%	35%	21%
4-5 months	5%	10%	12%	10%	11%
5-6 months	1%	2%	1%	1%	6%
more than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	16%
Average turnaround time in days	62 days	77 days	69 days	84 days	109 days
SENT TO REFEREES, REJECTED					
0-14 days	3%	21%	20%	6%	10%
15 days - 1 month	5%	3%	4%	4%	3%
1-2 months	31%	8%	6%	8%	7%
2-3 months	38%	30%	31%	40%	29%
3-4 months	18%	28%	29%	32%	20%
4-5 months	5%	8%	9%	8%	9%
5-6 months	0%	2%	1%	0%	6%
more than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	0%	15%
Average turnaround time in days	70 days	88 days	86 days	81 days	102 days
SENT TO REFEREES, RETURNED FOR REVISION					
0-14 days	13%	9%	5%	3%	2%
15 days - 1 month	1%	2%	0%	2%	0%
1-2 months	17%	6%	4%	2%	0%
2-3 months	35%	25%	18%	30%	25%
3-4 months	23%	35%	46%	34%	22%
4-5 months	10%	18%	26%	20%	21%
5-6 months	1%	6%	0%	3%	9%
more than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	6%	21%
Average turnaround time in days	79 days	93 days	95 days	95 days	146 days

Table 4: Time Taken for Referee to Return Report to Editor*

	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
0-14 days	16%	14%	15%	14%	15%
15 days -1 month	16%	8%	7%	8%	8%
1-2 months	49%	44%	40%	42%	43%
2-3 months	17%	28%	33%	29%	26%
3-4 months	1%	6%	5%	7%	6%
4-5 months	<1%	<1%	<1%	1%	<1%
5-6 months	0%	<1%	<1%	<1%	<1%
More than 6 months	0%	0%	0%	<1%	<1%
Average turnaround time	40 days	51 days	51 days	52 days	50 days

* Based on referees solicited in year t and having returned their reports by end of January of year t+1, first submissions.

Table 5: Journal Impact Factors

Year	The Economic Journal	The Review of Economics and Statistics	Journal of the European Economic Association	The Review of Economic Studies
2016	2.608	2.926	2.758	4.03
2017	2.946	3.510	2.975	4.455
2018	2.926	3.636	3.296	4.767
2019	2.764	4.345	3.388	4.890
2020	3.178	6.548	4.583	6.345
2021	3.721	6.481	4.301	7.833
2022*	3.2	8.0	3.6	5.8
2023	3.8	7.6	3.9	5.9

*In 2022 Clarivate reduced the number of decimal places included in Impact Factors.

Appendix

Top 12 Altmetric Scoring Articles*

 Subsidising the spread of COVID-19: Evidence from the UK'S Eat-Out-to-Help-Out... Article in Economic Journal, October 2021	 Are You Happy While You Work?* Article in Economic Journal, January 2016	 Is Legal Pot Crippling Mexican Drug Trafficking Organisations? The Effect of... Article in Economic Journal, November 2017
 Mathematics and Gender: Heterogeneity in Causes and Consequences* Article in Economic Journal, January 2015	 The Effect of Adult Entertainment Establishments on Sex Crime: Evidence from... Article in Economic Journal, July 2021	 Taking Back Control? Quasi-Experimental Evidence on the Impact of Retirement on... Article in Economic Journal, December 2023
 The Power of Bias in Economics Research* Article in Economic Journal, October 2017	 Malleability of Preferences for Honesty Article in Economic Journal, May 2024	 The Colour of a Free Ride Article in Economic Journal, September 2020
 Additional Returns to Investing in Girls' Education: Impact on Younger Sibling... Article in Economic Journal, March 2018	 I (Don't) Like You! But Who Cares? Gender Differences in Same-Sex and Mixed-Sex... Article in Economic Journal, January 2020	 Publishing While Female: are Women Held to Higher Standards? Evidence from Peer... Article in Economic Journal, May 2022

*As of 2 January 2025